

Tell Us How You're Feeling!



Welcome to Ed Session #3!

Case Intro and Case Starts



Last week's feedback – thank you for your input!

- 87% of you found last week's session helpful
- 50% of you are nervous about casing and 40% of you are nervous about networking

What you loved:

- Live examples, specifically odysseys from last week
- Leading with the "Why"
- When to use each version of the odyssey

What you want to see changed:

- Getting slides ahead of time
- More tips and experience with networking



We hear you!

A few notes from the CCR Ed team...



All CCR members were added to a G-Drive where the Ed team will be adding resources. There is also a slack channel "consulting-club" - engage!



The decks for Sunday sessions will be added right before each session



The recordings will be shared on a case-by-case basis. You should email the Ed team if you would like to request the recording



If you are not receiving emails from CCR, ensure you are signed up on CG



AVP Applications are open! Please apply [here](#)

Networking – What one path could look like...



Aman's experience from last year

- 9/21 - **First** Bain DC chat w/ FT consultant
- (Connected with multiple consultants at company presentation/ happy hour)
- 9/29 – Email with FT consultant, focused on Sustainability & Responsibility practice
- 10/24 - **Second** Bain chat (AAB facilitated)
- (Chats with on campus rep, chat through CCR Forum)
- 11/3 - **Third** Bain DC chat
- 11/3 – In person dinner with DC office in AA
- 11/18 - Q&A w/ DC recruiter during office hours
- INTERVIEW INVITE
- 11/10, 12/16 and 12/24 – mock cases with 1st and 2nd chats

***stayed connected with 3-4 key contacts throughout recruiting journey*



Success in networking is less strenuous than you are thinking! Don't focus on numbers.
Comparing yourself to others is a fast track to unnecessary stress and frustration...

Networking – What it might also look like!



Smarak's experience from last year with Bain

- 9/21 - **First** Bain Atlanta chat w/ FT consultant. Had my second coffee chat with Bain Chicago on the same day (not sure what city I wanted to recruit for).
- 9/23 – Had chats with multiple consultants during the presentation. They put me in touch with people from Chicago office

Long gap. Did not find much traction during this time. Stress at an all-time high!!

- 11/2 – Reached out to the OCR, got to speak with her the next day. Got added to case-prep session
- 11/4 – Got invited to Bain Chicago case prep. Developed a good rapport with the interviewer for this mock case, and spoke with her multiple times throughout the process
- 11/11 – Spoke with consultant during Forum, found my biggest supporter throughout the recruitment process

INTERVIEW INVITE!

Pro-tip – everyone's journey will look different. Once you connect with someone, keep that connection 'warm' throughout the process

Last Week:

- **Odyssey**
 - Why have one?
 - How to highlight your background
 - The components
- **Behavioral Questions**
 - What are they?
 - Picking stories
- **Resume Review**
- **Networking:** corporate presentations began

This Week:

- **Odyssey Prep:** You should have a working draft of your Odyssey
- **Networking:** company presentations continue & coffee chats begin!
- **Case Starts:** Prompts and clarifying questions

Cases: Getting Started

- ✓ Multiple plain sheets of paper
- ✓ A pen

+

- ✓ Your life experience
- ✓ Confidence
- ✓ Positivity
- ✓ Coachability
- ✓ Professionalism



Big Picture: How do I get a job in consulting?

- **Networking Phase (now – application deadlines)**
 - Coffee chats
 - Corporate presentations
 - Case competitions
- **Application Phase (November 1 – December 15)**
 - Resume
 - Cover letter*
- **Interview Phase (January 1 – February 15)**
 - First round* (**1-2 case interviews**, 1-2 FIT/behavioral interviews)
 - Final round* (**1-2 case interviews**, 1-2 FIT/behavioral interviews)

Completing a case successfully is key to getting a job in consulting!
You have at least 3 months to refine this skill...

**Note that the interview formats vary; cover letters are only needed for select firms*

- What is a case interview
- Introduction to Casing: Typical Case Structure and Common Case Types
- What are case interviews evaluating
- How did we prepare

What is case interview?

**Consultants solve real-life business problems,
often under high ambiguity**

- 1: Should Amazon enter the Singaporean market?
- 2: Should Microsoft acquire TikTok?
- 3: Should Spirit airlines start a full-service offering?
- 4: How can Exxon cut its costs to counter declining profits?
- 5: How can Uber increase its revenues when ride sharing slumps amidst a global pandemic?
- 6: How can Spotify unlock its next wave of growth?

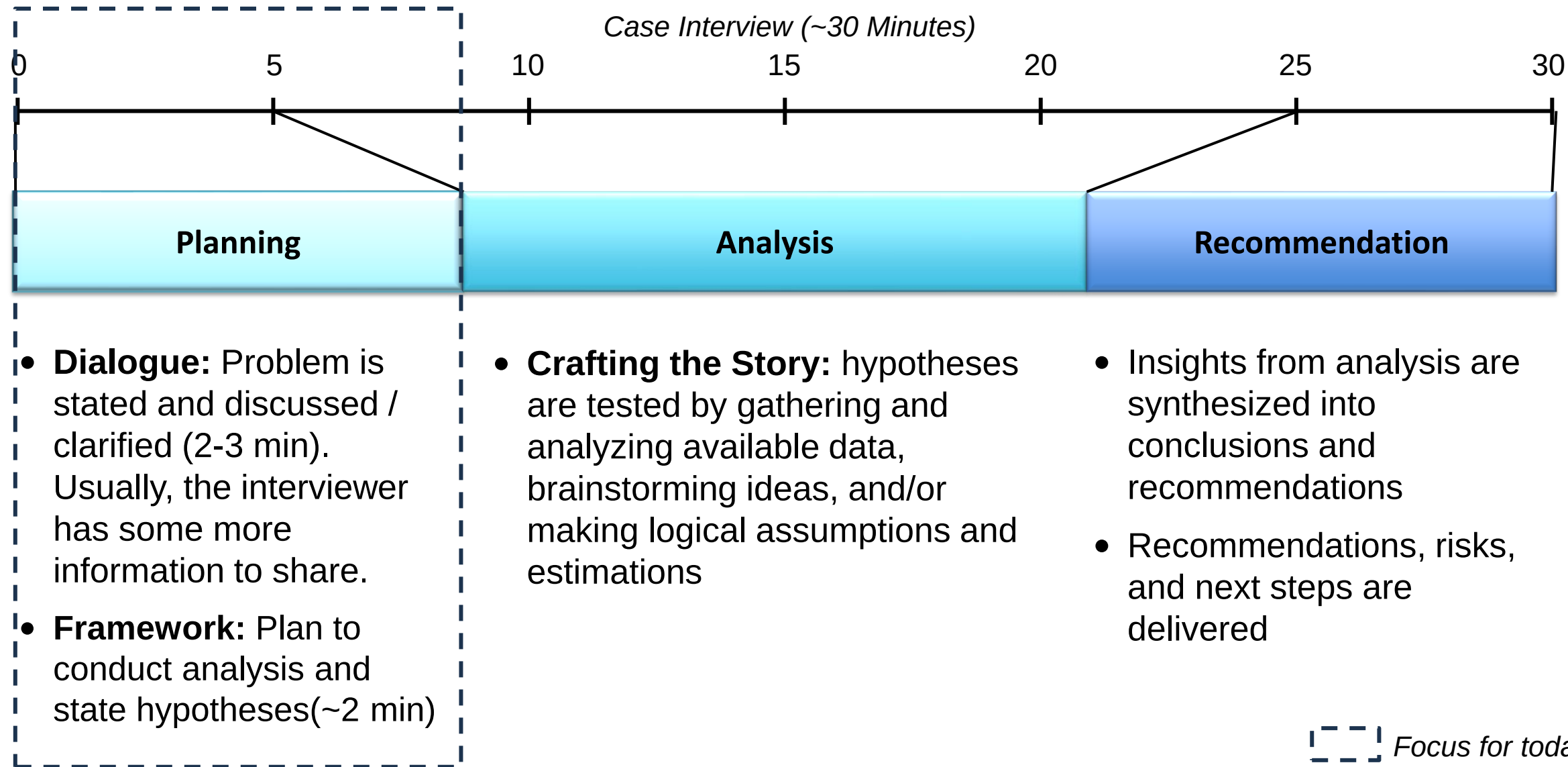
**A case is a simplified version of
a real-life business problem
that consultants solve**

“The business case is your opportunity to show us how you go about **solving sophisticated business problems** and how you **structure your thoughts**.”

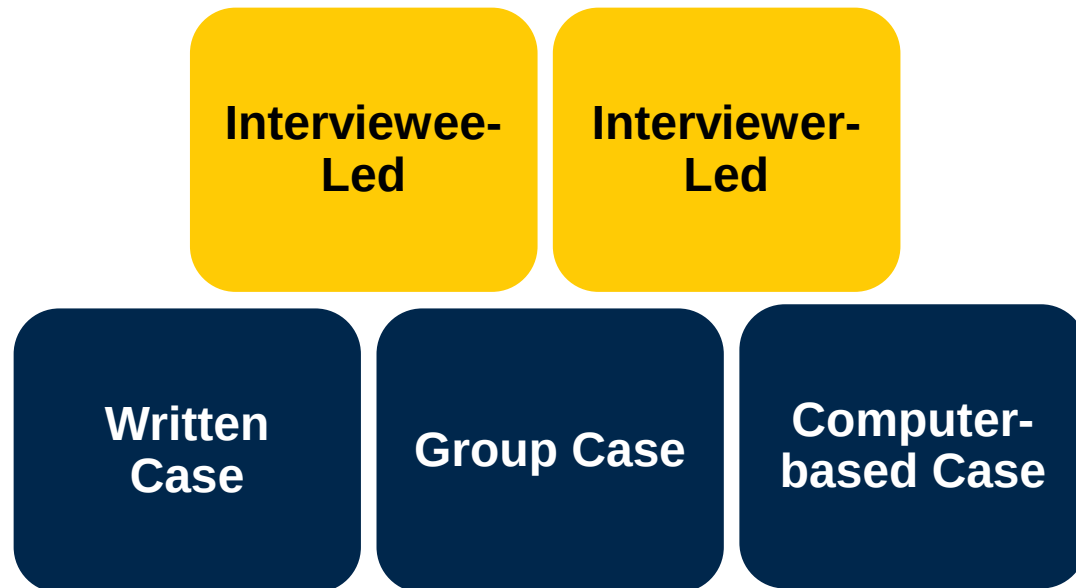
– *PwC Strategy&*

- What is case interview
- Introduction to Casing: Typical Case Structure and Common Case Types
- What are case interviews evaluating
- How did we prepare

Introduction to Casing: Typical Case Structure



Case Formats



Selective case topics (not exhaustive)



- What is case interview
- Introduction to Casing: Typical Case Structure and Common Case Types
- What are case interviews evaluating
- How did we prepare

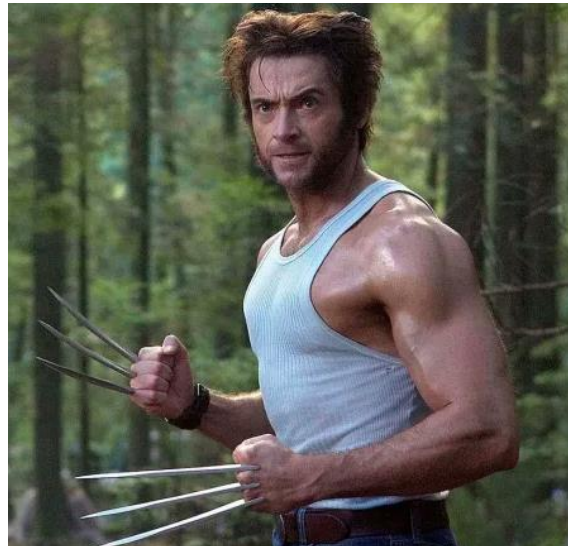
Evaluation Factors: Are you...

Hypothesis Driven: You can understand new situations and form a hypothesis to guide your analysis.

YOU, AN
INCREDIBLE
CONSULTANT

Structured: you can bring structure to complex problems; break them down to independent, manageable components

Analytical: There is analytical rigor to your conclusions and recommendations. Are you comfortable with numbers?



Engaged: Are you engaging and enjoyable to work with? You still need to be professional.

I must do a certain number of cases to succeed.

Each person is different! There is no magic number.

Just doing cases is enough practice.

You need to practice your weaknesses between cases with drills in order to improve.

Case prep is linear. I will do better each time.

You will improve over time but there will be bumps along the road.

I am not confident with mental math; I will be bad at casing.

Casing is about more than math! You will improve your math and show off your other strengths.

I am strong at mental math so casing will be a breeze.

Casing is about more than math! You will still need show analytical thinking, quantitative savviness **and** likeability.

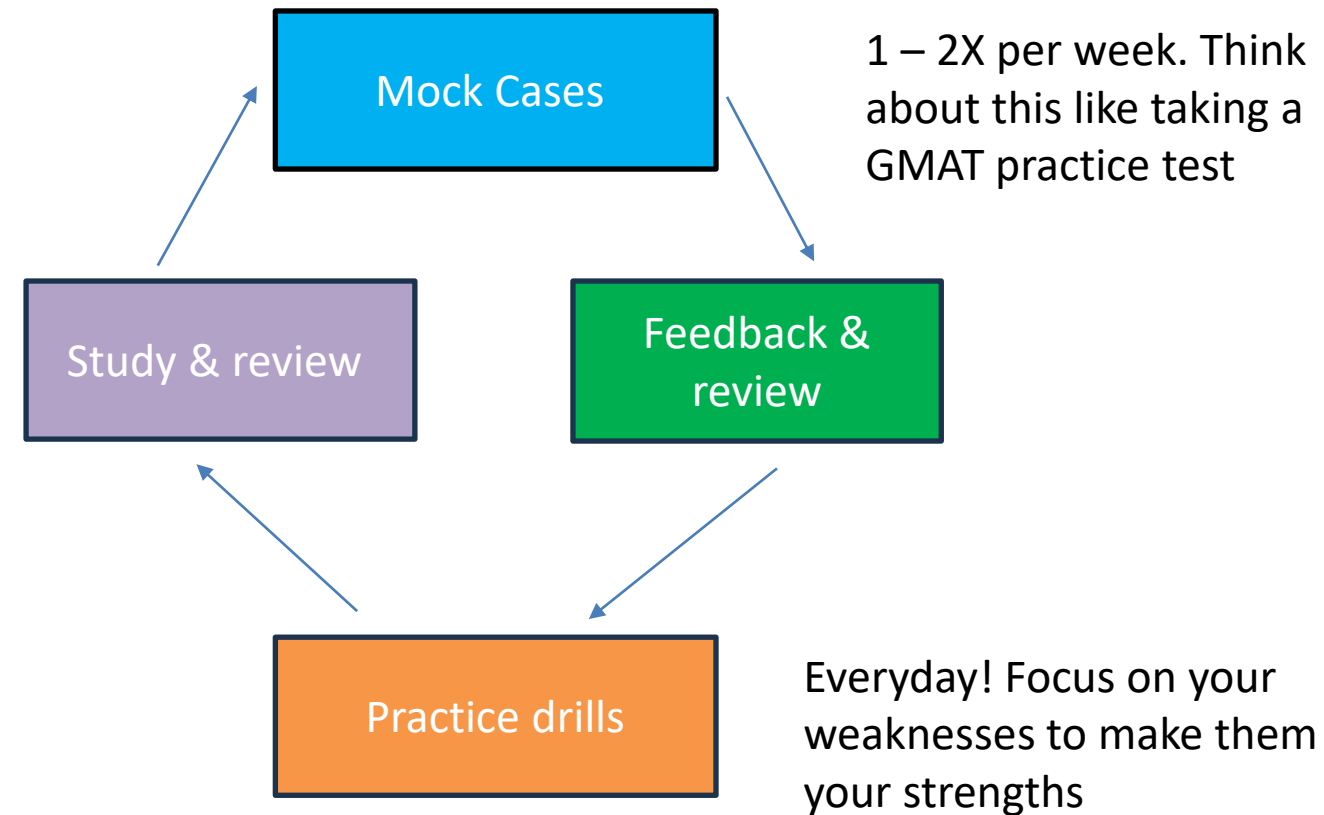
- What is case interview
- Introduction to Casing: Typical Case Structure and Common Case Types
- What are case interviews evaluating
- How to prepare
 - Perceptions & Reality: Case Interview Preparation
 - How did we prepare?
 - What are available resources?

What was Ashley's Experience?

- Had no idea what a "case" was until mid-October. Finally understood after watching "Observe a Pro" & Crafting Cases "The 9 Best in 2022"
- Did 1st case on October 19th because I was SO FREAKIN nervous to even begin. Had peer coach walk me through case as I pretended to know how to do math he was doing
- Over-indexed on casing without reviewing the cases at first...over winter break finally started reviewing cases and casing other people...made HUGE progress
- Did ~50 cases before 1st interview, felt this was a good number for me more or less
- Wished I had filmed myself more to see how I came across when casing (i.e. body language, eye contact, smiling, camera positioning)

What was Smarak's Experience?

- Smarak started with a case with his FACT Group leader on Sep 29, felt he bombed it
- Kept on going through 1-2 cases per week initially, felt he was improving steadily
- Hit a plateau in November – made similar mistakes a couple of times
- Changed strategy – 1 hour on case and feedback, 2 hours on reviewing that case later and thinking through it in detail
- Did ~35 cases before first interview, could have done with fewer



When doing mock cases:

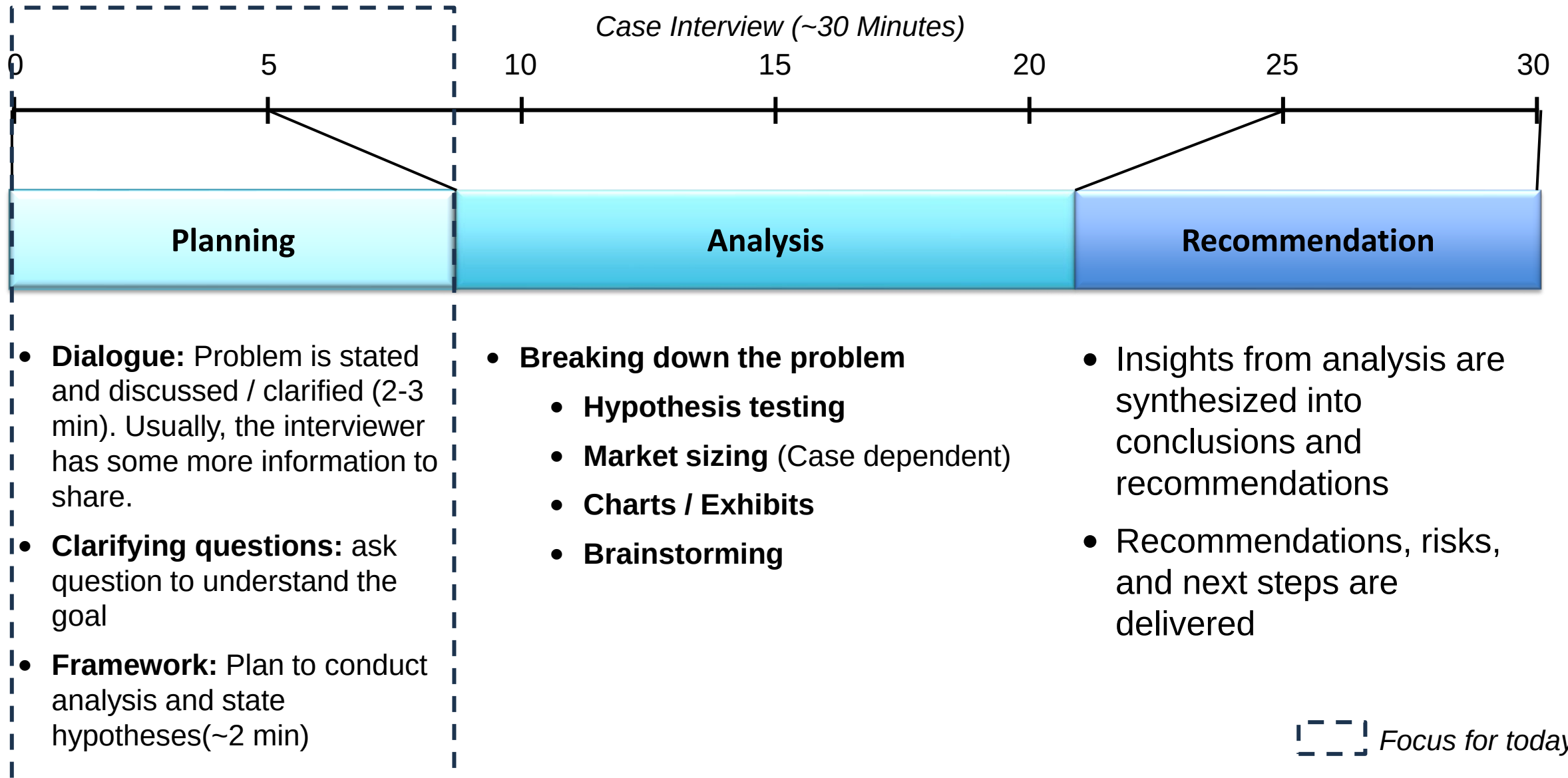
- After each mock case, spend time to revisit it. Look for ways to improve
- Take notes about your findings – Case log
- Take the feedback seriously – it's for you to improve
- Do cases with different people. Everyone's style is different, and you will have a lot of constructive feedback.
- Once you feel more comfortable, do cases with people who make you nervous to fail in front of OR ask your friend to impersonate someone who is less friendly

Maintain a detailed case log!

Case properties, summary				Performance						Other aspects
Case name	Case book, year	Type of case, primary	Level of difficulty	Prompt	Clarifying Questions	Framework	Brainstorming	Quant	Recs	Comments
<i>German Luxury Car Maker</i>	<i>Ross 2021</i>	<i>Market Entry</i>	<i>Medium</i>	Good ; did not miss anything in the prompt	Poor ; did a rephrase of the prompt, paused for a min, and then started speaking questions	Ok ; clear framework, however you missed competitors. You need to spell out the framework clearly in the beginning	Good ; thought of multiple ideas	Ok ; made 2 silly errors. Walk the person through the calculations rather than doing it all and then explaining	Poor ; you gave a full story. Also, give the next steps	1. Smile more, and relax 2. Tend to speak a lot - communication needs to be concise

- Case-log comments should be detailed and specific – you should know exactly the things that you are good at as well as the things that you need to work on
- Make sure to attach case logs on Ross Recruit for every peer coaching appointment!!

Introduction to Casing: Typical Case Structure



Our client, DairyCo., is a premier distributor of dairy products. It is looking to expand operations across the US. Their goal is to break even as soon as possible.



- What was common among Aman's approach and your approach? What were your main takeaways?
- What worked well?
- What could have been better?

1. **LISTEN!!**
2. Write down key words and numbers
3. Take a second to digest
4. Paraphrase to plug in information that you might have missed
5. Demonstrate that you understand the case and/or have some business intuition to the topic, or even a personal interest – **RELATE!**
6. Ask questions, but don't try to solve the case during discovery itself



Start a dialogue with your interviewer to confirm understanding, define the scope of the problem at hand and start making connections to the real world. This is your first impression during the case.

Practice Exercise 1 – do it in groups of 2/3 in your respective tables

Prompt – Hogwarts Inc. is a reputed vanishing ink maker. It has been suffering from a declining profit over the last few years. The CEO has been panicking about this and wants to turn this situation around. She has come to us for help. Please help her!

We are (almost) 100% sure that you guys have not worked with vanishing ink makers. So how do you relate to this, and think through this prompt?



Practice Exercise 2 – do it in groups of 2/3 in your respective tables

Prompt – Hogsmeade Cake Décor Inc. makes cake toppers and other ancillary items for cakes for Hogwarts. While they have had a healthy profit margin, the CEO is not satisfied – she wants to expand her company now. She has come to us seeking help. What do you tell her?



1. You **already know** frameworks!

- Pros & cons lists
- Decision trees
- How you decided to go to Ross

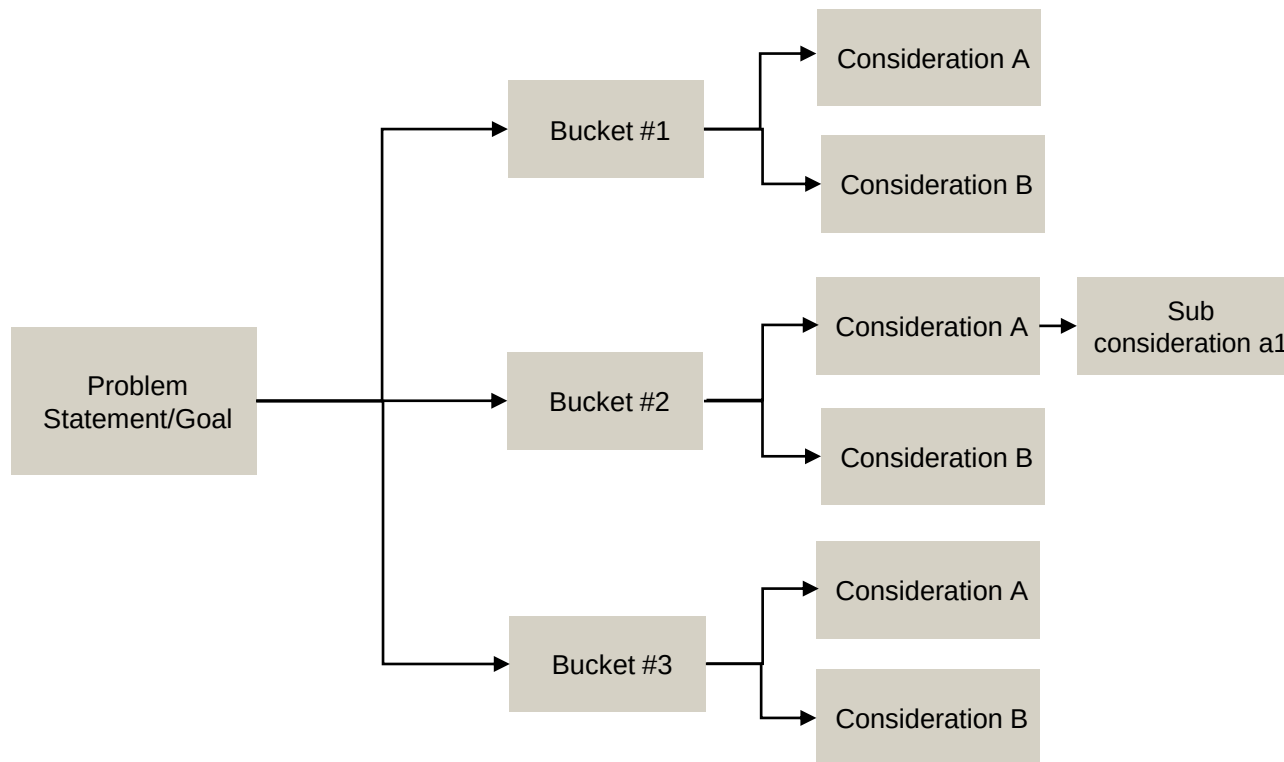
2. **Don't overthink this**

3. **Take your time at first**, speed will come over time

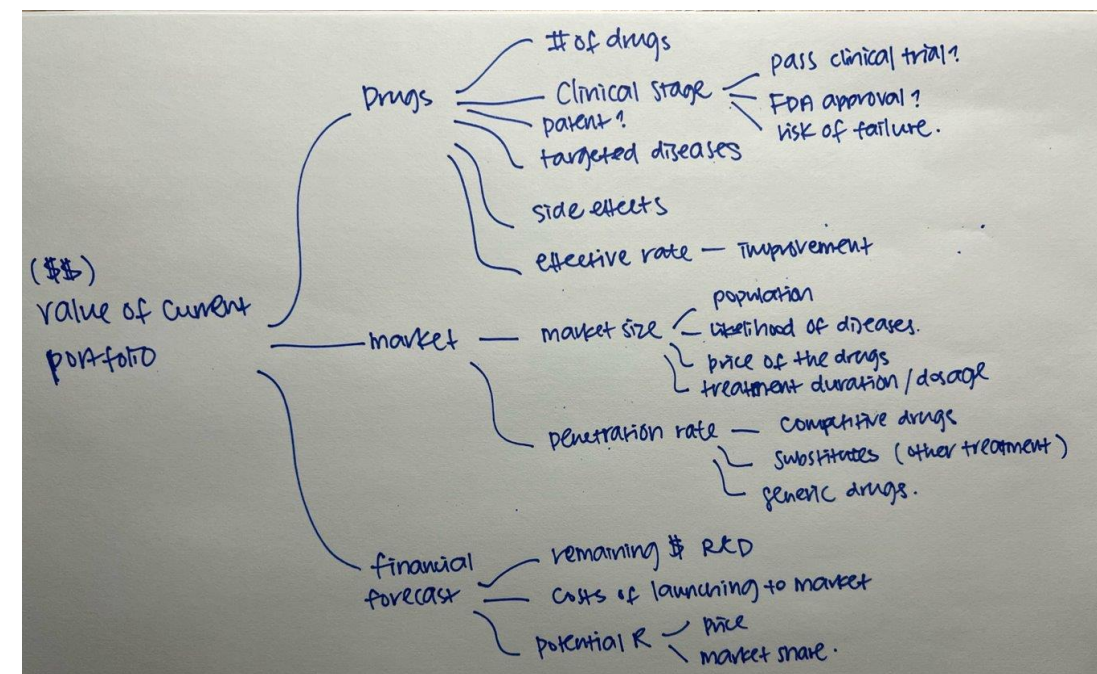
4. If you like a framework you did for a case type, write it down but **always be flexible!**

The framework is a plan for how you're going to solve the case

Theory



Application



- To summarize:
 - Listen deeply
 - Take good notes
 - Demonstrate understanding of case
 - Ask questions to develop understanding, not to solve the case then and there
 - Frameworks are not "scary", just your approach to get to the answer

- Go through [CDO's guide to Case Starts](#) in detail

1. Complete your resume: by the end of the week have your resume reviewed by at least 2 Peer Coaches (ideally 1 consulting peer coach)

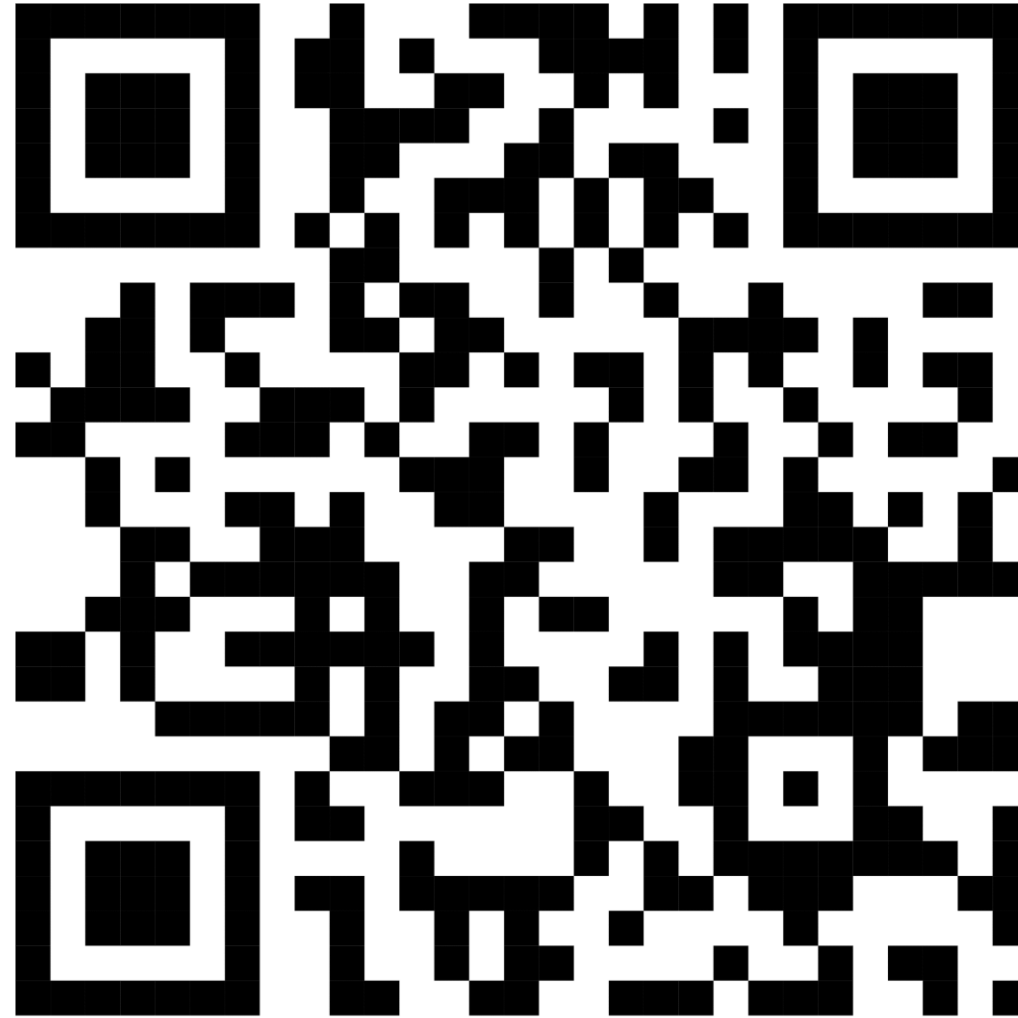
- Resumes become visible to recruiters in Ross Recruit from 10/10

2. Odyssey & Behavioral Prep:

Practice your first fit interview with your FACT group leader/ Peer Coaches and friends

Practice your odyssey with your FACT group, Peer Coaches and friends

Document your key stories



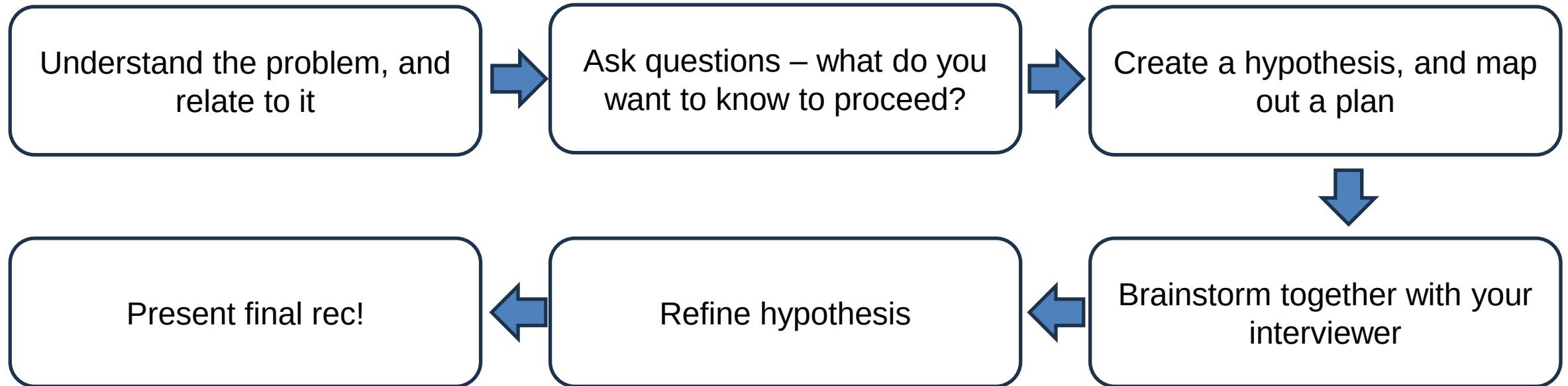
Case Prep First Principles

1. Treat case interviewers like clients with real problems

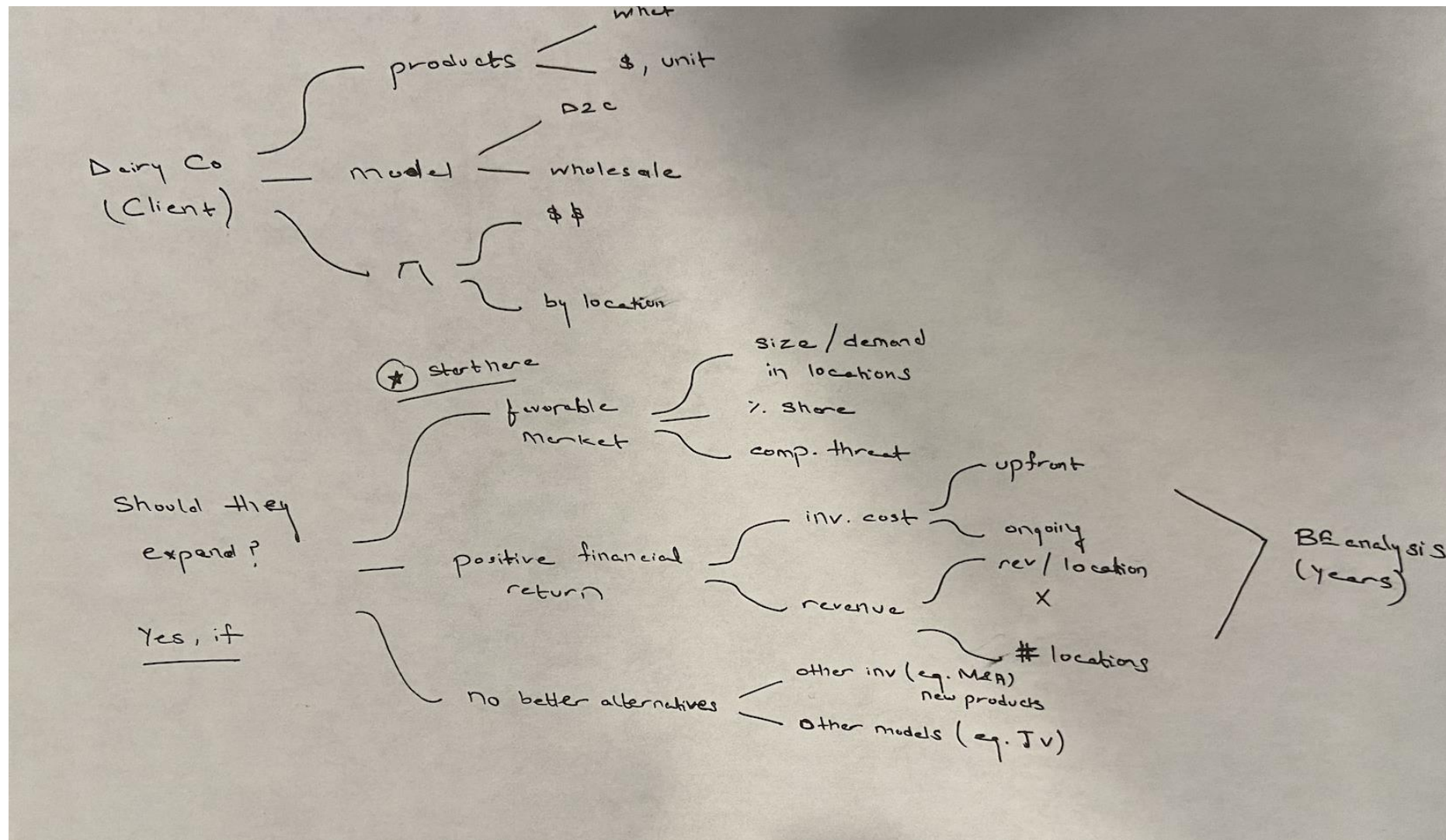
2. Interviewers want to know whether or not you spend your time effectively

3. Interviewers are interested in your problem-solving and interpersonal skills

So, how do you typically go through a case?



Case Start Example – Dairy Co.



Further reading:

- **Industry knowledge** (WSJ, Investopedia Industry Handbooks, Daily News, Talk to your classmates about the industry they come from, etc.)
- [Crafting Cases](#) offers top-of-the-line case prep materials. We strongly recommend you register with them, complete their free course on Case Interview Fundamentals, and read their [blog](#).
- Additional tips on the [CDO website](#)

Practice:

- Casebooks:
 - *Navigate to:* CC@R: '23 - '24 Materials (Public)
-- > Casebooks by School
 - Management Consulted Case Library
- Additional firm-provided materials:
 - [Accenture case interview workbook](#)
 - [Bain Video: Consultant Mock Interview](#)
 - [BCG Case Prep Tips and Cases](#)
 - [Deloitte case prep tool](#)
 - [McKinsey Practice Cases](#)
 - [Strategy& Tips](#)
 - Mock cases with firm consultants
- Drills:
 - [Management Consulted](#) (10K+ case drills)

Planning: Discovery & Dialogue after Prompt

A. LISTEN, LISTEN, LISTEN

- B. Write down key words and numbers
- C. Take a second to digest the prompt given (“I am going to take a second here”)
- D. Start a Dialogue: **This is a chance for you to show the interviewer that you are already thinking and making connections**

A. Lead discussion with analogies, and assumptions:

- A. “Our client is a large low-cost airline; can I assume that this is similar to Southwest?”
- B. “I read in the news that California is requiring all vehicles to be electric in the next decade, should we also be taking that into consideration for this case?”
- B. Ask questions the right way to **confirm understanding if needed** and will get you information you need

There is no need to repeat the entire prompt

- A. Spell out why you want to know: “I want to make sure I understand how this manufacturer makes money, do they sell directly to distributors or to retailers?”
- B. Demonstrate you are hypothesis driven by starting with some conjecture: “This company sounds like Apple. Is it safe to assume we're talking about phones and computers?”

A. Confirm scope and target:

- A. “Is there a specific target/goal in mind?”
- B. “Do we have any time constraints?”



Start a dialogue with your interviewer to confirm understanding, define the scope of the problem at hand and start making connections to the real world. This is your first impression during the case.